

אשר תעשו, a פרשה rich in השקפה and messages that we have to take home with us each and every day. The last pasuk in the parsha is one which doesn't get enough publicity (29:8): ושמרתם את דברי הברית הזאת: - למען תשכילו את כל אשר תעשו; - If you keep Hashem's bris; ושמרתם אתם אתם - We will be successful in whatever we do if we learn and follow the Torah. It's an outstanding and awesome (and here I use the word awesome on purpose) הבטחה, that if we keep the Torah, we will be successful.

I want to bring down another pasuk, which is brought down by R' Sheps' sefer מורשת שמחת התורה. R' Sheps was the ראש ישיבה in תורה ודעת. A very quiet and humble man, a very טייערער מענטש who was beloved by all. In his sefer he brings the pasuk (27:8) וכתבת על האבנים את כל דברי התורה הזאת באר היטב. This is referring a rather unusual and remarkable מצוה which doesn't get enough prominence, but it's a מצוה like any other one. What were בני ישראל supposed to do in their momentous entry into ארץ ישראל? Yeah, they're going to conquer the land, and there's going to be a כיבוש, you have to go and get the ברכות and כלל, but before you do that, as you cross the river, pick up some stones, put them up, plaster them, and afterwards write the whole Torah on them. A remarkable מצוה. What could this מצוה possibly mean to us? They were supposed to write the whole Torah, and in fact, the last two words are באר היטב. Rashi and the Ramban say on the spot, בשבעים לשון - not only did we write the whole Torah, but we wrote the entire Torah translated into seventy different languages. There are only two possibilities. They either wrote in micro-script, which the Ramban mentions, they wrote very tiny, or much more likely, it was all in נס, בדור, Hashem created a נס, in exactly the same way that Hashem can have all of כלל meet in front of the משכן, which is in פרשת שמני, all the millions of people stood right in front of the little משכן and they all fit in there. In exactly the same way, הקדוש ברוך הוא can fit the entire תורה and seventy translations onto a number of stones on the west side of the ירדן.

What is the purpose of telling us all of this? Rav Sheps brings down the גמרא in עבודה זרה, a tragic Gemara when they executed the תנא, רבי חנינא בן תרדיון, עשרה הרוגי מלכות, one of the תנאים, his students asked him, מה רב, מה? - What do you see? He answered, גוילין נשרפין - the parchment is being burned. However, אותיות - The letters are flying in the air.

They said, "Rebbi, what will happen to us? The Torah is being burnt." He said "Don't be afraid. The letters are flying in the air. Those letters are indestructible." That's what it means. פריחה means פריחה - planting and growing. All the דברי תורה will not simply last forever, but they will continue to flourish and blossom just like flowers will blossom. The נצחיות of the תורה is קיום. Even though everything seems to be destroyed and we're losing it, this נס of the תורה's נצחיות is embodied in these stones on the west side of the ירדן.

Yes, they wrote the Torah on these stones, but it was נס. In exactly the same way as it was a נס to write those stones as Rashi says, בשבעים לשון, so too the Torah's קיום is a נס and will last forever. That is the Ramban and Rav Sheps' message to us. There is no שריפה of the Torah.

No matter how many times the גוים burn our ספרי תורה, our Torah is נצחיות and we appreciate it as such. That is what this מצוה is telling us just as we go into ארץ ישראל. That was exactly the message. This Torah which I gave you in חוץ לארץ is exactly the same Torah דורות, certainly now when you're going into ארץ ישראל and you're coming back down to earth and not living a heavenly existence with ענני and מן. Back into nature, this same Torah is נצחיות and will maintain you לעולם ועד.

